

Drupal Playground

VIBING WEBFORM

Building webforms while vibing with AI

PDF

HI, I'M JACOB ROCKOWITZ

- My name is Jacob Rockowitz.
- I am known as jrockowitz on the web.
- I am a Drupal developer and software architect.
- I built and maintain the Webform module for Drupal.

jrockowitz.com

ME & AI

- I have been experimenting with AI in my Drupal playground at jrockowitz.com.
- My goal is to recognize what AI can and can't do.
- While accepting what AI is doing to our industry
- Simply put, AI can't be ignored, but it is still just a (powerful) tool.

[Read my blog](#)

This is my first webform module presentation in 5 years. Have patience and ask questions.

PART 1: WEBFORMS

Understanding and building webforms

PART 2: AI & WEBFORMS

Understanding how AI builds webforms

UNDERSTANDING THE WEBFORM MODULE

The Webform module allows you to build any type of form to collect any type of data, which can be submitted to any application or system.

[Learn more about Webform](#)

WHY WEBFORM (AND DRUPAL)

It provides all the features expected from an enterprise proprietary form builder combined with the flexibility and openness of Drupal.

THE USE CASE...

- **Build** a form or copy a template.
- **Publish** the form as a page, node, or block.
- **Collect** form submissions.
- **Send** confirmations and notifications.
- **Distribute** submissions to external systems.
- **Review** results online.
- **Download** results as a CSV.

BUILDING A WEBFORM

1. Create a feedback form.
2. Test the form.
3. View the submissions.
4. Sending email
5. Remote posting data
6. Place the form as a block.
7. Create a Webform node.

Let's do a demo

EXAMPLES, TEMPLATES, & DEMOS

The Webform module provides examples, templates, & demos that can be used as a starting point for building forms & applications.

EXAMPLES INCLUDED IN THE WEBFORM MODULE

- **Cards** - A multiple step 'cards' webform
- **Computed** - A computed elements
- **Custom Options** - Custom options element
- **Condition Logic** - Elements using conditional logic
- **Input Masks** - Elements with input masks
- **Style Guide** - Examples of all elements and layouts
- **Wizard** - A multiple step form

Learn by examples

TEMPLATES

- Templates are reusable forms.
- Changing or deleting a template does not change any existing forms.
- A form created from a template is a copy (a.k.a duplicate).

Using templates

DEMOS

- **Application Evaluation**

An evaluation form attached to applications

- **Event Registration**

A registration form that tracks which event a user has registered for

FEATURES

- Drag-n-drop form builder
- Multi-column layout
- Modal dialogs
- Conditional logic
- Open/close scheduling
- Prepopulate
- Email handling
- Remote post
- Submission limits
- Submission preview
- Autofill
- Save draft
- Auto purge
- Access controls
- Confirmation message
- Confirmation redirects
- Sharing

**THE WEBFORM MODULE SHIPS WITH
REASONABLE DEFAULT SETTINGS, BUT
EVERYTHING IS CUSTOMIZABLE.**

(AI understands everything is customizable)

FORM ELEMENTS

- Standard HTML inputs
- Advanced HTML inputs
- File uploads
- Signatures
- Buttons
- Rating
- Image selection
- Addresses
- Entity references
- Select menu enhancement
- Computed values
- Tooltips
- Slideouts
- Input masks
- Word/character counter
- Regex validation
- Access controls
- Unique values

FORM ELEMENT FEATURES

- **Definition** - Name, cardinality, & default value
- **Labels** - Title, description, “help” text & more
- **Display** - Prefix, suffix, size, input masks, etc
- **Validation** - Required, unique, pattern, counter, etc
- **Conditions** - Hide/show, required & disabled
- **Access** - Roles, user, or permission
- **Advanced** - Custom attributes & settings

Dissecting a form element

WEBFORM HANDLERS

A Webform Handler is a plugin in Drupal's Webform module that processes a webform submission — essentially, it defines what happens after someone submits a form.

WEBFORM HANDLER USE CASES

- Email notification and confirmation
- Push data to CRM.
- Subscribe to mailing lists.
- Flag a submission based on submitted values.
- Conditionally change confirmation message.

TYPES OF WEBFORM HANDLERS

- **Email & Scheduled Email**

Sends a webform submission via an email

- **Action & Settings**

Trigger a conditional action or setting on a submission

- **Remote Post**

Posts webform submissions to a URL

- **Debug**

Debug webform submission

FORM SETTINGS

- General
- Form
- Submissions
- Confirmation
- Email/Handlers
- CSS/JS
- Access

Walk-thru settings

GENERAL SETTINGS

- Disable saving of results.
- Use the webform as a template.
- Customize URL aliases.
- Ajaxify the form.
- Third party settings (for example, Honey_pot & Antibot)

FORM SETTINGS & BEHAVIORS

- Set open and close dates.
- Customize messages and labels.
- Pre-populate using query string parameters.
- Tweak multi-step wizard progress bar.
- Enable submission previews.

SUBMISSIONS SETTINGS & BEHAVIORS

- Submission labels and messages
- Submission limits
- Save drafts
- Submission purging
- Autofill

CONFIRMATION SETTINGS & BEHAVIORS

- Dedicated confirmation page
- Inline message
- Status message
- Modal confirmation dialog
- Redirect to external or internal URLs.

CUSTOM CSS & JAVASCRIPT

Site builders and front end developers can inject custom CSS & JavaScript to tweak a webform's look-n-feel and client-side behaviors.

- Tweaks font types and sizes
- Adjusts margins, padding, and layout
- Client-side validation and/or hide/show logic

ACCESS CONTROLS

Set access rules by role, user, and/or permission.

- Create
- View
- Update
- Delete
- Purge
- Administer

GLOBAL CONFIGURATION

Configuration defines the default features, functionality, & behaviors available to all webforms.

THINGS THAT SHOULD BE CONFIGURED

- Private file access for file uploads
- SPAM protection
- Available elements
- API keys
- Reusable options

CONFIGURATION

- Forms
- Elements
- Options
- Submissions
- Handlers
- Exporters
- Libraries
- Advanced

Explore configuration

ADD-ONS & EXTENSIONS (A.K.A. MODULES)

- Contributed modules extend Webform in every direction. (Entity generation, Views, and SPAM)
- Integrations connect Webform to services and platforms. (Salesforce, HubSpot, Mailchimp, Stripe, and Slack)

Finding add-ons

TYPES OF ADD-ONS

- SPAM Protection
- Validation
- Elements
- Integration
- Submissions
- Mail
- REST
- Configuration
- Migrate
- Multilingual
- Workflow
- Development

PART 2: AI & WEBFORMS

Understanding how AI builds webforms

**AI UNDERSTANDS THE WEBFORM MODULE
BECAUSE OF THE AMOUNT OF
DOCUMENTATION AND EXAMPLES.**

(Coding agents can figure out a module by reading the
code.)

WAYS TO APPROACH USING AI

- Chat (ChatGPT)
- Harness (Claude Code)
- Agents (Open Claw)

WEBFORM SPECIFIC PROMPTS AND QUESTIONS?

- What is the Webform module?
- How do I use Webform module?
- When should I use Webform?
- Why should I use Webform?
- Where can I use a Webform?

LET'S SEE WHAT AI CAN DO VIA CHAT

What is the best way to prevent SPAM via a Drupal Webform?

Provide a prompt to create a 'Request a medical appointment' form using the Webform module for Drupal and place it in a Drupal Recipe.

LET'S SEE WHAT AI CAN DO VIA A HARNESS

Create a 'Request a medical appointment' webform and place it in a 'recipes/webform_appointment' recipe.

Export my feedback form into a Drupal recipe called 'recipes/my_feedback'?

Add SPAM protection, using Honeypot, to the feedback webform in the 'recipes/my_feedback' recipe.

AI TIPS & TRICKS

Always have a plan and use skills like <https://github.com/obra/superpowers> to brainstorm.

Als can make mistakes, especially when they have to guess at the answers without context.

Use AI as a tool to learn Drupal,
and not as a way to not learn Drupal.

APPROACHING AI

- Be **curious**
- Open to a **challenge**
- Share your **experience**

Q&A

Questions, use cases, and prompts worth exploring
next

THANKS!!!

Learn more about me at jrockowitz.com.